Practice workbook · Normal balances: debit side or credit side

Knowing which side each class of account normally balances on, whether in the ledger or the trial balance, and reading what a cash or bank balance means.

22 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 21 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: ACC-REC-19

1. Question 12 · part whole · 5 marks

2023 NOV · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

12 Identify, indicating with a tick (✓), on which side of a trial balance **each** would be shown.

Account	Debit	Credit
Carriage inwards		
Carriage outwards		
Equity		
Other receivables		
Other payables		

(Total for Question 12 = 5 marks)

Working and answer

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2. Question 1 · part whole · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

1 Which account has a credit balance?

- ☒ A Discount allowed
- ☒ B Discount received
- ☒ C Purchases
- ☒ D Sales returns

(Total for Question 1 = 1 mark)

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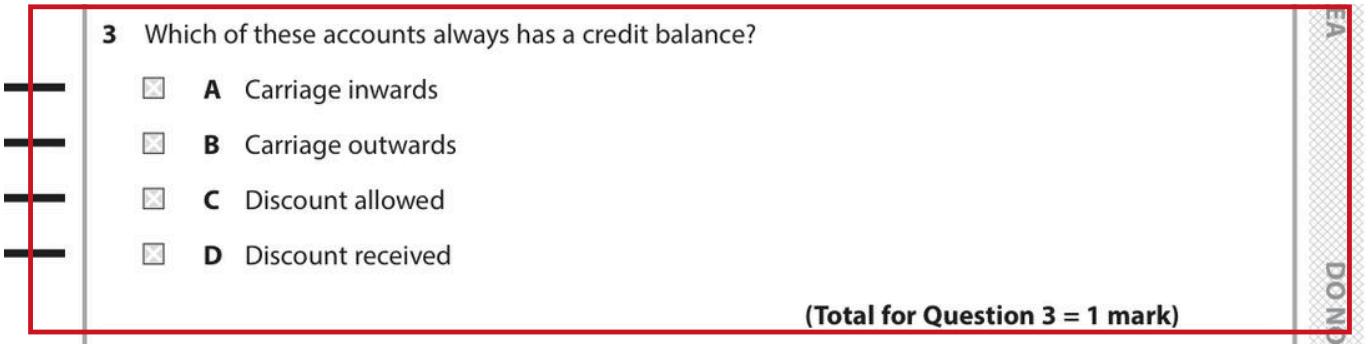
Working and answer

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3. Question 3 · part whole · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



3 Which of these accounts always has a credit balance?

- ☒ **A** Carriage inwards
- ☒ **B** Carriage outwards
- ☒ **C** Discount allowed
- ☒ **D** Discount received

(Total for Question 3 = 1 mark)

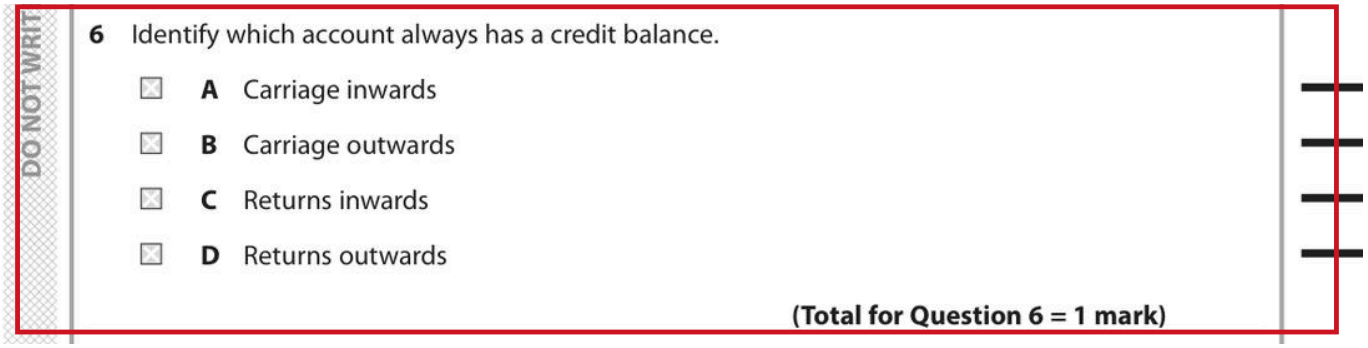
Working and answer

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4. Question 6 · part whole · 1 mark

2021 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.


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6 Identify which account always has a credit balance.

- ☒ **A** Carriage inwards
- ☒ **B** Carriage outwards
- ☒ **C** Returns inwards
- ☒ **D** Returns outwards

(Total for Question 6 = 1 mark)

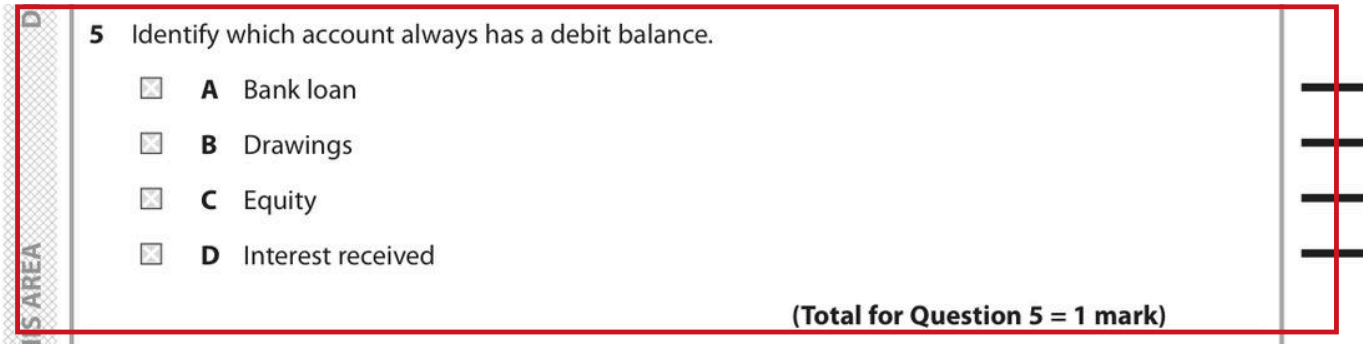
Working and answer

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5. Question 5 · part whole · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



5 Identify which account always has a debit balance.

- ☒ **A** Bank loan
- ☒ **B** Drawings
- ☒ **C** Equity
- ☒ **D** Interest received

(Total for Question 5 = 1 mark)

Working and answer

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6. Question 3 · part whole · 1 mark

2023 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

3 Identify which **one** of the following accounts would **always** have a debit balance.

☒ **A** Bank current

☒ **B** Bank deposit

☒ **C** Bank interest

☒ **D** Bank loan

(Total for Question 3 = 1 mark)

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Working and answer

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7. Question 3 · part whole · 1 mark

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

3 Identify which account always has a credit balance.

- ☒ **A** Carriage inwards
- ☒ **B** Carriage outwards
- ☒ **C** Discount allowed
- ☒ **D** Discount received

(Total for Question 3 = 1 mark)

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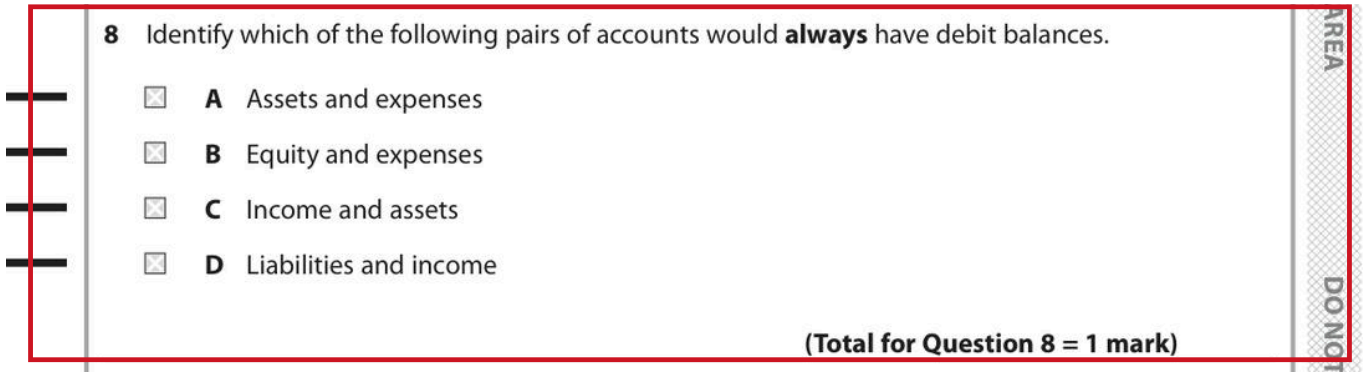
Working and answer

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8. Question 8 · part whole · 1 mark

2024 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



8 Identify which of the following pairs of accounts would **always** have debit balances.

- ☒ **A** Assets and expenses
- ☒ **B** Equity and expenses
- ☒ **C** Income and assets
- ☒ **D** Liabilities and income

(Total for Question 8 = 1 mark)

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Working and answer

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9. Question 7 · part whole · 1 mark

2025 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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7 Which of the following pairs of accounts always has a credit balance?

- ☒ **A** Assets and expenses
- ☒ **B** Equity and expenses
- ☒ **C** Income and assets
- ☒ **D** Liabilities and income

(Total for Question 7 = 1 mark)

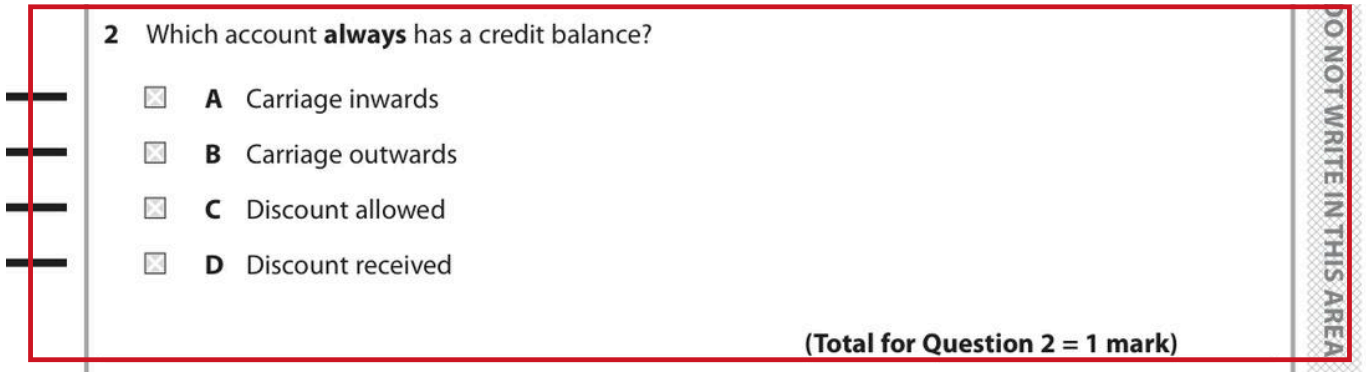
Working and answer

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10. Question 2 · part whole · 1 mark

2025 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



2 Which account **always** has a credit balance?

- ☒ **A** Carriage inwards
- ☒ **B** Carriage outwards
- ☒ **C** Discount allowed
- ☒ **D** Discount received

(Total for Question 2 = 1 mark)

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

Working and answer

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11. Question 1 · part whole · 1 mark

2023 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

1 Identify what a debit balance of $100 in a cash account represents.

- ☒ **A** Cash had been overspent by $100
- ☒ **B** Cash in hand was $100
- ☒ **C** Total cash paid out was $100
- ☒ **D** Total cash received was less than $100

(Total for Question 1 = 1 mark)

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Working and answer

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12. Question 3 · part whole · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

3 Identify what an opening credit balance of $1 500 in a business bank account represents.

- ☒ **A** Business has an overdraft of $1 500
- ☒ **B** Business has $1 500 in the bank
- ☒ **C** Owner's equity is $1 500
- ☒ **D** Owner's equity is $3 000

(Total for Question 3 = 1 mark)

DO NOT

Working and answer

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13. Question 3 · part whole · 1 mark

2024 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

3 Identify what an opening debit balance of $1 500 in a business bank account represents.

- ☒ **A** Business has an overdraft of $1 500
- ☒ **B** Business has $1 500 in the bank
- ☒ **C** Owner's equity is $1 500
- ☒ **D** Owner's equity is $3 000

(Total for Question 3 = 1 mark)

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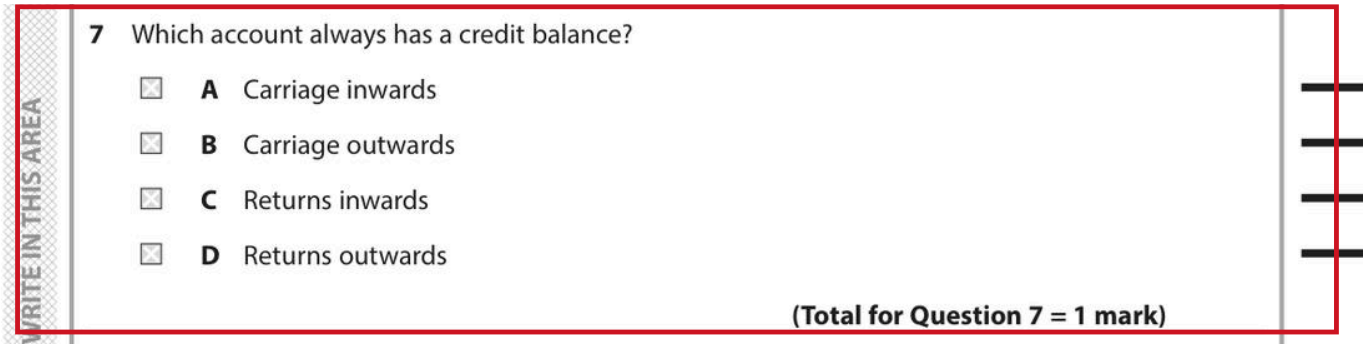
Working and answer

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14. Question 7 · part whole · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



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7 Which account always has a credit balance?

- ☒ **A** Carriage inwards
- ☒ **B** Carriage outwards
- ☒ **C** Returns inwards
- ☒ **D** Returns outwards

(Total for Question 7 = 1 mark)

Working and answer

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15. Question 2 · part whole · 1 mark

2023 JAN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

2 Identify which of these accounts **always** has a credit balance.

- ☒ **A** Carriage inwards
- ☒ **B** Carriage outwards
- ☒ **C** Discount allowed
- ☒ **D** Discount received

(Total for Question 2 = 1 mark)

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Working and answer

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16. Question 6 · part whole · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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6 Identify which account would **always** be shown on the credit side of a trial balance.

- ☒ **A** Bank
- ☒ **B** Drawings
- ☒ **C** Equity
- ☒ **D** Petty cash

(Total for Question 6 = 1 mark)

Working and answer

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17. Question 10 · part whole · 1 mark

2024 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

10 Identify which account would appear on the credit side of a trial balance.

- ☒ **A** Carriage inwards
- ☒ **B** Carriage outwards
- ☒ **C** Discount allowed
- ☒ **D** Discount received

(Total for Question 10 = 1 mark)

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18. Question 4 · part whole · 1 mark

2025 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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4 Which account balance could appear on either the debit side or the credit side of a trial balance?

- ☒ **A** Bank
- ☒ **B** Cash
- ☒ **C** Drawings
- ☒ **D** Equity

(Total for Question 4 = 1 mark)

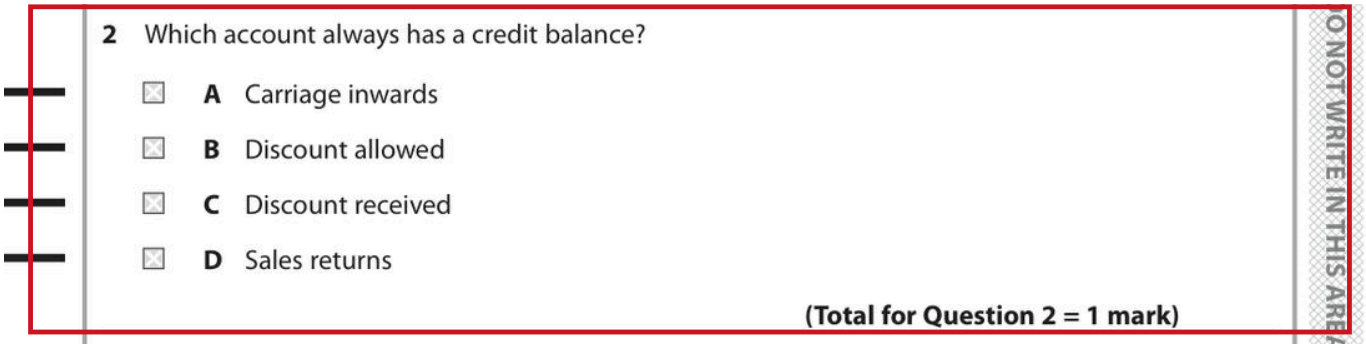
Working and answer

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19. Question 2 · part whole · 1 mark

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



2 Which account always has a credit balance?

- ☒ **A** Carriage inwards
- ☒ **B** Discount allowed
- ☒ **C** Discount received
- ☒ **D** Sales returns

(Total for Question 2 = 1 mark)

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20. Question 14 · part b · 10 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

14 (a) State **one** advantage and **one** disadvantage of preparing a trial balance.

(2)

Advantage

.....

.....

Disadvantage

.....

.....

(b) Complete the table, using a tick (✓), to identify in which column of the trial balance each item would be entered. The first item has been completed as an example.

(10)

	Debit	Credit
Inventory	✓	
Bank overdraft		
Carriage inwards		
Discount received		
Drawings		
Equity		
Machinery – provision for depreciation		
Provision for irrecoverable debts		
Rent received		
Returns inwards		
Trade receivables		

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20. Question 14 · part b · 10 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(c) Identify the type of error in **each** scenario.

(3)

Scenario	Type of error
A payment for general expenses had been posted to the drawings account.	
A payment for stationery had been posted to the rent paid account.	
An invoice for $320 had been recorded in the purchases day book as $230.	

(Total for Question 14 = 15 marks)

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20. Question 14 · part b · 10 marks · Working and answer

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21. Question 14 · part c · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

14 (a) State **two** purposes of preparing a trial balance. (2)

1 .....

2 .....

(b) State **one** difference between:

(i) an error of commission and an error of principle (2)

.....

.....

.....

.....

(ii) an error of original entry and an error of omission. (2)

.....

.....

.....

.....

(c) Identify, indicating with a tick (✓), where each account balance would be shown in a trial balance. (4)

Account	Trial balance	
	Debit $	Credit $
Carriage inwards		
Carriage outwards		
Returns inwards		
Returns outwards		

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21. Question 14 · part c · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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(d) Identify which principle of professional ethics is being described.

(2)

	Principle of professional ethics
Accountants must operate in a straightforward and honest manner.	
Accountants must be free from bias or conflict of interest.	

(e) Identify which accounting concept is being applied in **each** scenario.

(3)

Scenario	Accounting concept
A trader uses the same method of depreciation each year.	
A trader makes an adjustment in the financial accounts for amounts paid in advance.	
A trader records the purchase of an item of stationery as a business expense.	

(Total for Question 14 = 15 marks)

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21. Question 14 · part c · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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22. Question 12 · part whole · 5 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

12 Identify, indicating with a tick (✓), on which side of the trial balance **each** balance would be entered.

Balance	Debit	Credit
Carriage outwards		
Equity		
Mortgage		
Returns inwards		
Trade receivables control		

(Total for Question 12 = 5 marks)

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Working and answer

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